



#WCBLR

Bengaluru

WordPress in 2026

Build. Create. Automate. Contribute.

FOR YOU

Pre-final & final-year engineering students

THE QUESTION

Why should a developer care about WordPress in 2026?

CAMPUS REACH 2026

WORDPRESS 7.1

You already know the web. You may not know the platform.

40.3%

of all websites use WordPress

58.8%

CMS market share

61.3%

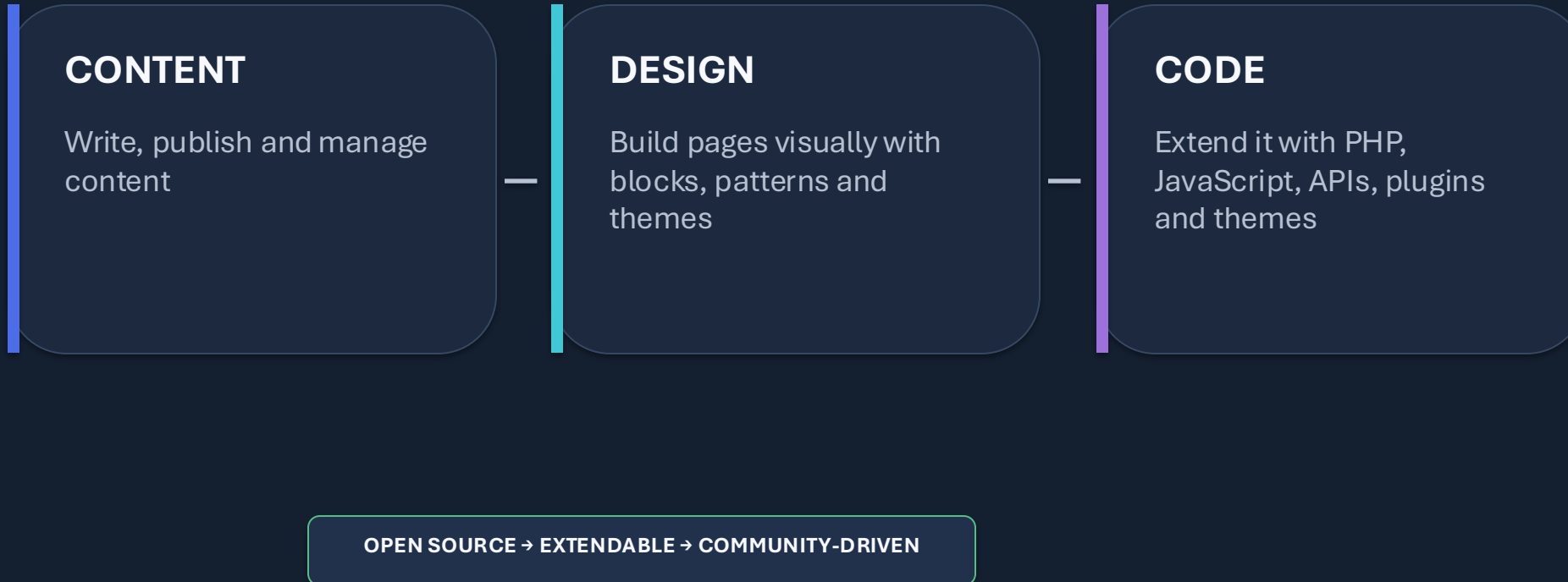
of WordPress sites use v7

WHY CARE?

A huge installed base means a huge ecosystem of products, agencies, freelancers, plugins, themes and developer work.

- It is not “just a blog.”
- It is open-source software + an ecosystem + APIs + a developer platform.
- And the platform is changing quickly because of AI.

First: what exactly is WordPress?



The WordPress story changed in the last year

THEN

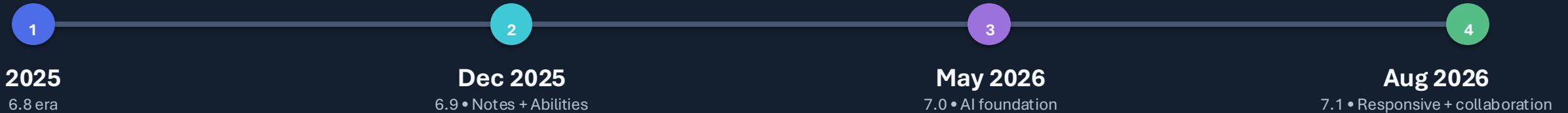
WordPress was already visual, extensible and community-driven.

NOW

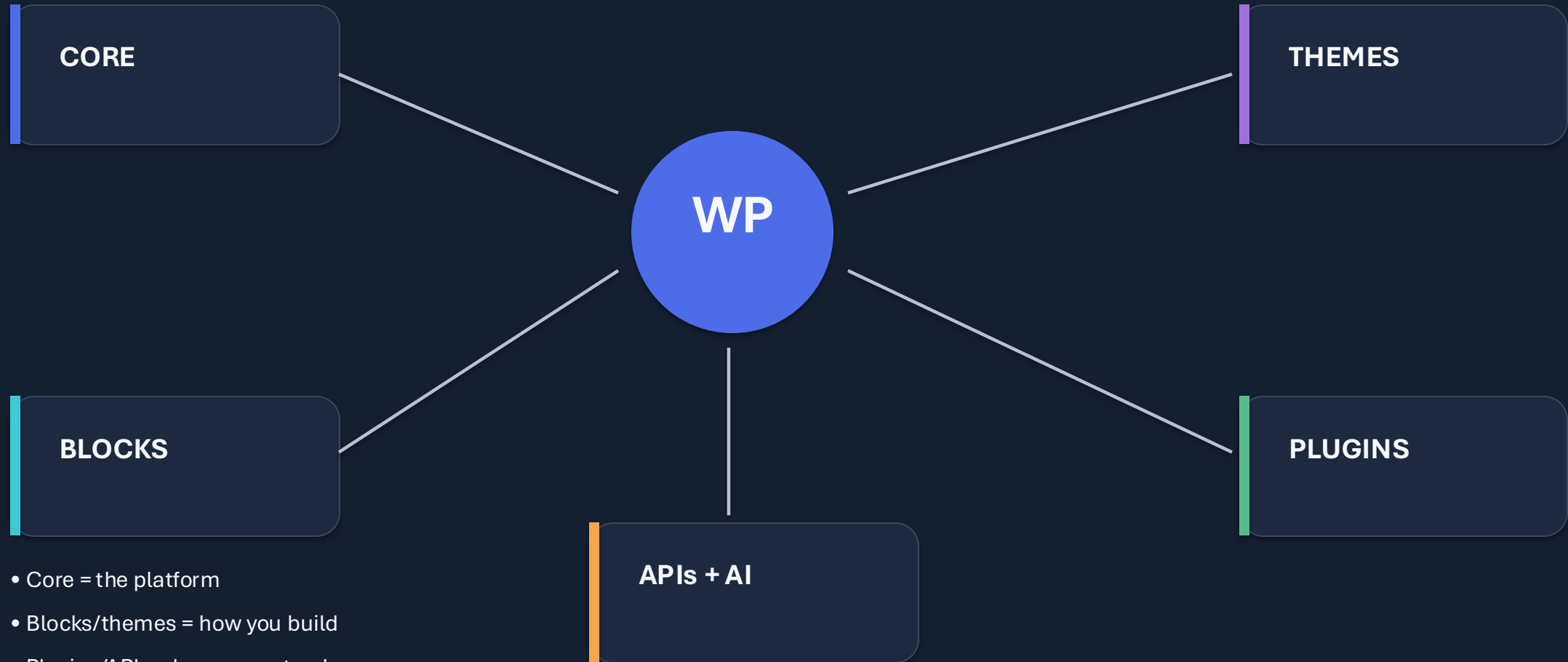
It is adding AI, automation, richer collaboration and stronger developer APIs.

SO WHAT?

The skills around WordPress are expanding—not shrinking.

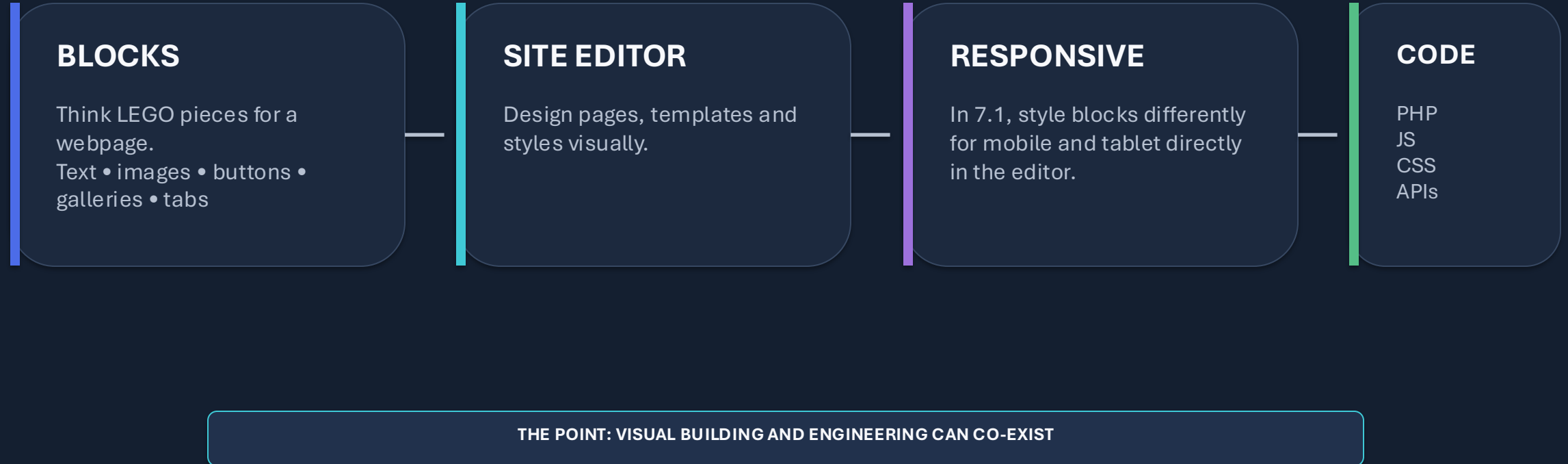


Think of WordPress as an ecosystem



- Core = the platform
- Blocks/themes = how you build
- Plugins/APIs = how you extend
- AI = a new layer for creating and automating

Build visually — without giving up code



AI is no longer just a plugin sitting on top

2025 MINDSET

“Install an AI plugin.”

AI helps write, translate, generate images, suggest SEO and more.

2026 MINDSET

“Let WordPress communicate with AI and expose capabilities AI can use.”

WHAT ENABLES IT

AI Client
Connectors
Abilities API
Client-side abilities

WORDPRESS 7.0 = FOUNDATION FOR AI ACROSS THE EXPERIENCE

- AI providers remain external; WordPress provides a common way to connect and use them.
- The goal is not “AI replaces developers.” It is “AI can work with the platform developers build.”

APIs: the part engineers should pay attention to

WITHOUT API

Your app cannot easily ask WordPress to do things.

REST API

Move data between WordPress and other applications.

WITH APIs

Your app can request data or trigger supported capabilities.

ABILITIES API

A standardized, discoverable way to register and run WordPress capabilities.

AI AGENT

Can discover/use exposed capabilities through the growing WordPress AI/developer stack.

ENGINEERING OPPORTUNITY: BUILD THE BRIDGE

Imagine this: an AI-assisted WordPress workflow



IMPORTANT: HUMAN REVIEW STILL MATTERS

Websites are team projects now

NOTES

Leave feedback where the content lives.

MENTIONS

@mention the right collaborator.

REVIEW

Discuss, refine, then publish.

- 6.9 introduced Notes and block-level collaboration.
- 7.1 expands Notes with inline feedback, rich text and @mentions.
- That maps closely to real product/content workflows.

Where can this take you?

Developer

PHP • JS • APIs

Block / Theme Dev

Gutenberg • theme and json

AI + WP

AI APIs • Abilities • automation

QA / Security

Testing • accessibility • secure code

Design / UX

Layouts • responsive • systems

Content / SEO

Editorial • search • analytics

Agency / Freelance

Build • maintain • consult

Open Source

Core • docs • support • events

YOU DON'T HAVE TO CHOOSE ONE ROLE FOREVER

If you're an engineering student, what should you learn?

FOUNDATION

HTML • CSS • JavaScript • Git

WORDPRESS

Blocks • Themes • PHP • Site Editor

ENGINEERING

REST API • Webhooks • Testing • Security

2026 EDGE

AI APIs • Abilities • Automation • Agents

PROFESSIONAL

Communication • Documentation • Accessibility

You can contribute before you are an expert

CODE

Core / plugins / themes

TEST

Find bugs, verify fixes

DOCS

Tutorials, handbooks

TRANSLATE

Make software accessible globally

SUPPORT

Forums, learning, community

EVENTS

Meetups, WordCamps, workshops

OPEN SOURCE = A WAY TO BUILD EXPERIENCE IN PUBLIC

Let's build: a 30–45 minute challenge

- 01 Pick a problem** College club • event • portfolio • small business
- 02 Build the page** Use blocks, patterns and responsive styling
- 03 Add one integration** Form • API • analytics • external data
- 04 Add one AI use** Draft • summarize • alt text • content idea
- 05 Review + publish** Check mobile, accessibility and content

THE GOAL IS NOT A PERFECT WEBSITE — IT'S A WORKING IDEA

So... why WordPress in 2026?

SCALE

A massive real-world web ecosystem.

ENGINEERING

APIs, blocks, themes, plugins and automation.

AI

A platform increasingly designed to work with AI.

- Learn the fundamentals.
- Build something real.
- Contribute in public.
- Use AI as a multiplier—not a substitute for thinking.

Don't just use WordPress. Join the ecosystem.

LEARN

Learn WordPress
Documentation • Tutorials •
Playground

MEET

Meetups • WordCamps
Developers • Designers • Agencies

CONTRIBUTE

Code • Test • Docs
Support • Events

BUILD SOMETHING. THEN SHARE IT.

WordPress Isn't Just for Small Websites

Some well-known organizations using WordPress across their digital presence:

**Microsoft • Meta • Disney • NASA • CNN • TIME • TED
• Capgemini • Qualtrics • Hilton • Tata Motors • Harvard
• PlayStation • Impelsys • Onyx • DeltaThink**

WordPress can power anything from a student project to an enterprise digital platform.

Corporate websites • Newsrooms • Blogs • Campaigns • Investor Relations • Education • Publishing • Enterprise Platforms

Sources & presenter reference

- WordPress 7.0 “Armstrong” — WordPress.org News (20 May 2026)
- WordPress 7.1 “Mary Lou” — WordPress.org News (19 Aug 2026)
- WordPress 6.9 “Gene” — WordPress.org News (2 Dec 2025)
- WordPress Developer Blog — Abilities API, AI-powered plugin guidance and 7.1 developer updates
- W3Techs — WordPress usage statistics, 14 Sep 2026
- 2025 campus deck supplied for this project — structural baseline

CHECK LOCAL EVENT DETAILS + QR CODES BEFORE PRESENTING

WordCamp Bengaluru — Learn. Connect. Contribute.

A community conference around WordPress, open source and the wider web ecosystem

WHAT IS WORDCAMP?

A community-organised, not-for-profit conference focused on WordPress — development, design, content, business, AI, accessibility, open source and more.

It brings together developers, designers, creators, students, entrepreneurs and WordPress enthusiasts.

WHAT YOU CAN GET

- Learn from practitioners
- Meet people from the ecosystem
- Discover different technology careers
- Explore WordPress + AI
- Experience open source contribution
- Build your professional network

FOR A STUDENT

You don't have to wait until you have 5 years of experience.

Start by attending a meetup, asking questions, learning from others and making your first contribution.

Campus → Community → Career

WORDCAMP BENGALURU 2026

WordCamp Bengaluru 2026

21–22 November 2026 · Bengaluru

SATURDAY — CONTRIBUTOR DAY

21 November 2026

Bangalore International Centre, Domlur

Learn how to contribute to WordPress through code, design, documentation, translation, testing and other contributor teams.

SUNDAY — MAIN CONFERENCE

22 November 2026

St. Joseph's Boys' High School, Museum Road

2 tracks · Talks · Workshops · Networking

A chance to learn from and interact with people working across the WordPress ecosystem.

2026 focus: WordPress + AI — including the direction toward the agentic web.

FROM CAMPUS TO COMMUNITY

Why should an engineering student attend WordCamp?

Turn a technology you use into a community you can learn from and contribute to

- Learn from practitioners working on real-world web technologies
- Meet developers, designers, creators and technology professionals
- Discover career paths beyond a single programming language
- Explore how WordPress is evolving with AI and automation
- Experience open source and learn how contributions are made
- Build a professional network while still in college

Student

Meetup

WordCamp

Contribute

Build

Career

Don't just use technology. Meet the people building it. Contribute to it.

STAY CONNECTED

Join the WordPress Bengaluru Community

Stay updated on meetups, WordCamp Bengaluru, learning opportunities and community conversations.

WhatsApp Community

Join the Bengaluru WordPress community chat

<https://chat.whatsapp.com/EVICNw9zZy6LI6TpxrqXc>

Meetup

Monthly Bengaluru WordPress meetups and events

<https://www.meetup.com/bengaluruwordpress/>

LinkedIn

Bengaluru WordPress community

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/bengaluru-wordpress>

X / Twitter

@WPBengaluru

<https://x.com/WPBengaluru/>

Instagram

@wordpressbengaluru

<https://www.instagram.com/wordpressbengaluru/>

Follow • Join • Meet the community